RESUME

Resume Writing Guide & ATS Blueprint

Anatomy of an ATS-Compliant Tech Resume

1. ATS (Applicant Tracking System) Fundamentals

- Avoid complex graphics, tables, dual columns, text boxes, and icons that confuse parsing algorithms.
- Standard Margins & Typography: 0.5 - 0.75 inch margins; clean fonts like Inter, Arial, Calibri (10-11pt).
- File Format: Single-page PDF named cleanly: 'FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf'.
- Keyword Optimization: Mirror essential tech skills directly from job descriptions.

2. Strategic Section Structure

- Contact Header: Full Name, Professional Email, Phone Number, LinkedIn URL, GitHub Profile URL, Location.
- Education: Degree, Major, University, CGPA (especially if >= 7.5), Year of Graduation.
- Technical Skills: Categorized into Languages, Frameworks, Databases, Tools/Platforms.
- Experience / Internships: Reverse chronological order with metrics-driven bullet points.

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High-Impact Bullet Points & Project Showcases

3. The Google XYZ Formula for Bullet Points

- Formula: 'Accomplished [X] as measured by [Y], by doing [Z]'.
- Weak: 'Built a web application for campus placements.'
- Strong: 'Developed a responsive placement tracking portal used by 1,200+ students, reducing application processing time by 45% using Spring Boot and React.'
- Strong Action Verbs: Engineered, Architected, Spearheaded, Accelerated, Optimized, Automated.

4. Common Resume Red Flags to Avoid

- Vague generic summaries ('Hardworking student seeking entry level job...').
- Rating skills with arbitrary star bars (e.g. 4/5 stars in Java).
- Unverified claims or projects with broken/empty GitHub repositories.
- Spelling and grammatical mistakes — always peer-review before upload.